

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Data Analytics and Business Intelligence English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For data analysts, BI developers, analytics engineers, data scientists, reporting teams, business analysts, and data-driven managers.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

- 01 Agreeing on a metric
- 02 Dashboard refresh failure
- 03 Duplicate records
- 04 Clarifying a request
- 05 Association and causation
- 06 Experiment imbalance
- 07 Data access request
- 08 An executive readout

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Agreeing on a metric

An analyst and stakeholder define active customers.

Roles: BI analyst / Sales operations manager

BI analyst: Does active customer mean a signed contract or a purchase in the reporting period?

Sales operations manager: For this dashboard, at least one completed purchase in the last 90 days.

BI analyst: Should canceled and fully refunded orders count?

Sales operations manager: No. Let's write those exclusions into the definition.

BI analyst: I'll document the time zone, source tables, and refresh schedule too.

Sales operations manager: Send the definition for review before building the chart so other teams can use the same measure.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Does active customer mean a signed contract or a purchase in the reporting period?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Dashboard refresh failure

A stakeholder reports stale dashboard figures.

Roles: Business stakeholder / Data engineer

Business stakeholder: The dashboard hasn't changed since yesterday. Have sales stopped?

Data engineer: No conclusion about sales follows from that. The scheduled data load failed overnight.

Business stakeholder: Can you show users the last successful refresh time?

Data engineer: Yes. I'll mark the dashboard as stale and investigate the failed job.

Business stakeholder: I'll pause this morning's performance comparison until the data are current.

Data engineer: I'll confirm the repaired load and completeness checks before telling you the dashboard is ready.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The dashboard hasn't changed since yesterday. Have sales stopped?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Duplicate records

An analyst finds a sudden increase after a data join.

Roles: Data analyst / Analytics engineer

Data analyst: Revenue doubles after I join orders to shipments. The source order total hasn't changed.

Analytics engineer: Is the join one-to-many? An order can have several shipments.

Data analyst: Yes. I'm repeating the order amount for each shipment row.

Analytics engineer: Aggregate at the intended grain before comparing, and check the join keys.

Data analyst: I'll reconcile distinct orders and revenue to the source totals.

Analytics engineer: Document the grain in the model so future reports don't repeat the same error.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Is the join one-to-many? An order can have several shipments." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Clarifying a request

A manager asks for every available customer field.

Roles: Analytics lead / Marketing manager

Analytics lead: What decision will the customer extract support?

Marketing manager: We want to understand which onboarding step has the highest drop-off.

Analytics lead: Then we may need event counts by step rather than a broad personal-data export.

Marketing manager: Agreed. Could we also compare acquisition channels?

Analytics lead: Yes, subject to data availability and access rules. I'll propose the smallest useful dataset.

Marketing manager: I'll confirm the decision and reporting period so we can review whether the analysis answers the question.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "What decision will the customer extract support?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Association and causation

A team reviews a regional sales comparison.

Roles: Analyst / Regional manager

Analyst: Regions using the new script sold more, but the comparison is observational.

Regional manager: Can we say the script caused the increase?

Analyst: Not from this alone. Those regions also had different staffing and customer mixes.

Regional manager: What would strengthen the evidence?

Analyst: A suitable experimental or carefully justified comparison design, with its limitations explicit.

Regional manager: For now, describe the association accurately and recommend how to evaluate the script more rigorously.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Can we say the script caused the increase?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Experiment imbalance

An analyst checks an experiment before interpreting results.

Roles: Experiment analyst / Product lead

Experiment analyst: The allocation ratio differs sharply from the planned split. We need to investigate that first.

Product lead: Could the favorable result still be real?

Experiment analyst: Possibly, but assignment or logging problems could bias it. Significance doesn't fix a broken design.

Product lead: I'll keep the rollout decision pending.

Experiment analyst: I'll review eligibility, assignment, and event completeness with engineering.

Product lead: Bring the validity findings alongside the outcome metrics, so the decision reflects the quality of the evidence.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Could the favorable result still be real?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Data access request

A department requests access to a restricted dataset.

Roles: Department analyst / Data steward

Department analyst: I need the employee-level dataset for a turnover report. What access is appropriate?

Data steward: Start with the purpose and required fields. An aggregated dataset may meet the need.

Department analyst: I only need trends by department and tenure band.

Data steward: Then let's assess that output and any small-group disclosure concerns under our policy.

Department analyst: I'll submit the request with the audience and retention period.

Data steward: I'll route it for the required approval and confirm the permitted dataset and handling conditions.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "I need the employee-level dataset for a turnover report. What access is appropriate?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

An executive readout

An analyst prepares a concise performance explanation.

Roles: Senior analyst / Finance director

Senior analyst: Orders fell eight percent, while revenue fell three percent. Higher average order value offset part of the volume decline.

Finance director: Is that price or product mix?

Senior analyst: The current bridge suggests mix, but I still need to reconcile discount effects.

Finance director: Lead with the confirmed movement, then identify that open question.

Senior analyst: I'll include the comparison period, reconciliation status, and the largest contributing categories.

Finance director: Good. Recommend the next analysis without presenting an unverified driver as a settled explanation.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Is that price or product mix?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Metric Definitions and Business Questions

SHARED CASE

Two teams report different active-user totals. One counts logins; the other counts completed transactions.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

What action qualifies a user as active, and over what period? The two totals use different definitions. Let's agree on the business question and label each measure clearly.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Data Quality and Trust

SHARED CASE

A dashboard refreshed today, but one source table contains data only through Monday. A manager assumes all figures are current.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

The dashboard refreshed today, but that table is current only through Monday. I'll show the source's data cutoff separately from the dashboard refresh time.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Dashboards and Executive Reporting

SHARED CASE

A KPI card shows a monthly total without its target, comparison period, or definition. The reader cannot interpret whether the result is favorable.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

The total needs context. I'll add the definition, reporting period, and relevant comparison so the reader can understand what changed and whether action is needed.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Causation, Correlation, and Caveats

SHARED CASE

Customers who attend training renew more often. Attendance was voluntary, and the groups may differ in motivation.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

Training attendance is associated with renewal in this dataset. That does not establish causation; the groups may differ in other ways. I'll state the finding with that limitation.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

SQL, Models, and Transformation Logic

SHARED CASE

A report joins order rows to several payment rows per order. Revenue appears larger after the join.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

What does one row represent in each table? The join may repeat order values when there are multiple payments. Let's check the grain and aggregation before interpreting the total.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Experiment Readouts and Statistical Thinking

SHARED CASE

An experiment estimates a positive effect, but the interval includes values close to no change. The slide presents only the point estimate.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

I'll show the estimated effect and its uncertainty together. The point estimate alone hides the range of values compatible with the analysis and can make the result sound more certain than it is.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Data Governance and Privacy

SHARED CASE

An analyst wants customer-level data but has not specified which fields are needed or how long they will be retained.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you define the analysis purpose, necessary fields, and retention period? That will let the appropriate team review access and privacy requirements before the data is shared.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Insight Storytelling and Recommendations

SHARED CASE

A report lists ten findings but no recommended action. The audience has five minutes to decide whether to investigate a service issue.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

I'll lead with the finding relevant to that decision, explain its limitation, and recommend a specific investigation. The other findings can support the discussion without obscuring the request.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Active by login or completed transaction?

Fictional metric discussion using the lesson case: two teams report different active-user totals because one counts logins and the other completed transactions.

01 • Operations manager: Your active-user total differs from the product team's. Which dashboard should we call the source of truth?

02 • BI analyst: First clarify the business definition. Their metric counts logins, while ours counts users completing transactions.

03 • Operations manager: Then the disagreement isn't necessarily a calculation error; the label hides two different activities.

04 • BI analyst: Exactly. Which business question do you need the number to answer in this meeting?

05 • Operations manager: I want to know how many people completed the service task, not merely entered the system.

06 • BI analyst: Then transaction-based activity is relevant, but we should still confirm its period and counting rules.

07 • Operations manager: Could both measures remain useful if their names distinguish them rather than competing for one vague label?

08 • BI analyst: Yes. Assign an owner to each definition and avoid presenting the totals as interchangeable.

09 • Operations manager: I'll ask the product team to review the labels with us before we publish another comparison.

10 • BI analyst: I'll bring the current definitions and mark any unresolved exclusions so the discussion stays precise.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An order placed is not an order fulfilled

Fictional operations reporting: sales counts orders placed, while fulfillment counts orders shipped; both reports use the label orders this week.

01 • Sales operations lead: Our weekly order count is higher than fulfillment's. Could the warehouse be missing records?

02 • Analytics lead: Possibly, but first check the event definition. Sales counts placement, and fulfillment counts shipment.

03 • Sales operations lead: So an order placed this week may belong to another week's shipment count.

04 • Analytics lead: Correct. We need the business question before deciding which metric is appropriate.

05 • Sales operations lead: For staffing, the warehouse wants the work actually shipped during the week, not demand arriving.

06 • Analytics lead: Then use the shipment-based definition for that purpose and retain placement counts for demand analysis.

07 • Sales operations lead: Could you also clarify whether a split shipment counts once or more than once?

08 • Analytics lead: That rule isn't established here. I'll ask the metric owner rather than assume a counting grain.

09 • Sales operations lead: Let's label the two reports clearly and keep the split-shipment question open until confirmed.

10 • Analytics lead: Agreed. A source of truth needs an explicit definition, not simply a preferred dashboard name.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Revenue before or after refunds?

Fictional reporting clarification: two internal summaries use revenue but one subtracts refunds; tax treatment and reporting period are unspecified.

01 • Commercial manager: These revenue totals disagree. Could you clarify whether both include the same transactions and adjustments?

02 • BI analyst: One subtracts refunds, while the other doesn't. Tax treatment and reporting period also need confirmation.

03 • Commercial manager: Then choosing the larger number would not resolve the business-definition problem.

04 • BI analyst: Correct. We should identify what decision this summary supports and obtain the approved definition from its owner.

05 • Commercial manager: I need an operational comparison, not advice about accounting recognition or what to report externally.

06 • BI analyst: Understood. I'll keep the discussion within the internal metric and refer accounting questions to the appropriate specialist.

07 • Commercial manager: Please ask the owner about refunds, tax treatment, and the time boundary before reconciling the totals.

08 • BI analyst: I will. I'll also retain both source calculations rather than overwrite one without understanding the difference.

09 • Commercial manager: Once the definitions are clear, we can decide whether the reports should use different names.

10 • BI analyst: Exactly. The first outcome is a shared meaning, followed by a comparison using consistent rules.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Metric Definitions and Business Questions

Two teams report different active-user totals. One counts logins; the other counts completed transactions.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: What action qualifies a user as active, and over what period? The two totals use different definitions. Let's agree on the business question and label each measure clearly.

Scenario 2 | Does a reopened ticket count again?

A fictional service dashboard reports tickets resolved this month. The brief does not say whether a ticket resolved twice after reopening counts once or twice. The support manager needs a workload measure. Clarify the event and counting unit.

Role A: BI analyst: ask whether the question concerns unique tickets or resolution actions.

Role B: Support manager: explain the workload purpose and identify the definition owner.

Possible opening: For workload, do you want unique tickets or each resolution action, including work after reopening?

Success checks

- Distinguish objects from repeated events.
- Connect the definition to the business question.
- Agree a precise label and owner review.

Add a complication: The manager asks to keep the same label for both measures.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A refreshed dashboard contains Monday's source data

Fictional data-quality update using the lesson case: the dashboard refreshed today, but one source table contains data only through Monday.

01 • Business manager: The dashboard refreshed today. Can I assume every figure includes activity through this morning?

02 • Data analyst: No. One source table only contains data through Monday, despite today's dashboard refresh.

03 • Business manager: Then the display update completed, but the underlying source freshness is different.

04 • Data analyst: Exactly. The pipeline can refresh a report without receiving newer records from every source.

05 • Business manager: Does that prove the Monday data is inaccurate, or only that later activity is missing?

06 • Data analyst: The known issue is the coverage date. We haven't established that the existing records are incorrect.

07 • Business manager: Please make the affected source and cutoff visible so readers don't treat all totals as current.

08 • Data analyst: I'll label that boundary and ask the source owner for the pending update status.

09 • Business manager: Can you promise the missing activity will appear tomorrow if the dashboard runs again?

10 • Data analyst: Not without source confirmation. I'll report the next verified update rather than assume refresh means completeness.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A successful pipeline with a missing region

Fictional reporting handoff: a pipeline run succeeded, but its input manifest contains files from three of four expected regions.

01 • Operations director: The pipeline is green. Does that confirm the regional report is complete for all four regions?

02 • Data engineer: The run succeeded technically, but the input manifest includes only three of the four expected regions.

03 • Operations director: So the success status tells us the available input was processed, not that all input arrived.

04 • Data engineer: Correct. Completeness remains unresolved for the missing region even though the processing step finished.

05 • Operations director: Should its missing values be displayed as zero sales until the file arrives?

06 • Data engineer: No. Missing data isn't evidence of zero activity. We should label that region's figures unavailable.

07 • Operations director: Please request the source status and explain which comparisons are affected by the gap.

08 • Data engineer: I'll contact the regional data owner and retain the input manifest with the update.

09 • Operations director: Then today's report can show completed processing and incomplete coverage without concealing either.

10 • Data engineer: Agreed. I'll confirm when the missing source is received and checked before calling the report complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Corrected records have not reached the report

Fictional data-quality case: duplicate source records were corrected, but the dashboard has not rerun since that correction.

01 • Source owner: We corrected the duplicate records. Can you tell users the dashboard totals are fixed now?

02 • BI analyst: The source correction is complete, but the dashboard hasn't rerun since that change.

03 • Source owner: Then the displayed totals may still reflect the earlier records until processing and verification finish.

04 • BI analyst: Exactly. We need to distinguish source repair, pipeline refresh, and checking the resulting report.

05 • Source owner: Could a scheduled refresh be treated as completed remediation because it usually succeeds?

06 • BI analyst: No. A planned run isn't an observed result, and we still need to verify the affected totals.

07 • Source owner: I'll provide the correction record and identify the affected keys through the normal data-quality channel.

08 • BI analyst: Thank you. I'll use that scope to check the refresh outcome without changing unrelated figures.

09 • Source owner: Please keep the user update clear about what has been repaired and what remains pending.

10 • BI analyst: I will. We'll confirm the displayed correction after the run and validation, not before.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Data Quality and Trust

A dashboard refreshed today, but one source table contains data only through Monday. A manager assumes all figures are current.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The dashboard refreshed today, but that table is current only through Monday. I'll show the source's data cutoff separately from the dashboard refresh time.

Scenario 2 | A late file has arrived but failed checks

A fictional missing source file has arrived, but its row-count check failed and the reason is unknown. It has not been included in the report. Explain completed receipt, pending validation, and the effect on completeness.

Role A: Data engineer: report the file's actual processing status.

Role B: Business owner: ask whether arrival alone means the dashboard is complete.

Possible opening: The file arrived, but it has not passed validation or entered the report yet.

Success checks

- Separate receipt from validated inclusion.
- Do not invent the reason for the failed check.
- Agree an owner update before changing the completeness claim.

Add a complication: The business owner asks to remove the missing-data notice immediately.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A monthly total without an interpretation frame

Fictional dashboard review using the lesson case: a KPI card has a monthly total but no target, comparison period, or definition.

01 • Executive reader: This monthly total looks large. Is that a good result for the business?

02 • Dashboard designer: The card doesn't provide enough context. We need the metric definition, relevant comparison, and any agreed target.

03 • Executive reader: Could you color it green so readers know what conclusion to draw immediately?

04 • Dashboard designer: Not until a favorable threshold is established. A color shouldn't invent an assessment the evidence doesn't support.

05 • Executive reader: Please explain the difference between a number and a key performance indicator, or KPI.

06 • Dashboard designer: A KPI connects a defined measure to a performance question; the isolated total doesn't show that connection.

07 • Executive reader: Would a drill-down solve the missing definition if readers click into the detailed records?

08 • Dashboard designer: Detail can help investigation, but the overview still needs enough context to interpret its headline.

09 • Executive reader: I'll ask the metric owner for the target and comparison basis rather than guess them.

10 • Dashboard designer: I'll update the card once those are confirmed and show any missing context explicitly meanwhile.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A target is not an alert threshold

Fictional service dashboard: an agreed monthly target exists, but the team has not defined an operational alert threshold.

01 • Service manager: We have a monthly target. Can the dashboard send an alert whenever a daily result misses it?

02 • BI developer: A monthly target and a daily alert threshold answer different questions. We haven't defined that daily rule.

03 • Service manager: Could you explain the distinction without implying we should ignore daily performance completely?

04 • BI developer: The target describes a desired monthly outcome; an alert rule identifies conditions that need timely attention.

05 • Service manager: Then we need a reviewed daily interpretation rather than apply the monthly number to every day.

06 • BI developer: Exactly. Otherwise the dashboard may signal a problem based on an inappropriate comparison period.

07 • Service manager: I'll ask the operational owner what daily condition should trigger investigation and what context matters.

08 • BI developer: Please include the intended response, so the threshold supports an action rather than just another notification.

09 • Service manager: Until then, show daily data without presenting it as an approved pass-or-fail judgment.

10 • BI developer: Agreed. We can keep the monthly KPI and the proposed daily alert clearly separate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A total can conceal where a service problem occurs

Fictional service report: an overall delay measure is available, but regional breakdowns have not been reviewed.

01 • Operations director: The overall delay measure is stable. Can I say every region is performing consistently?

02 • BI analyst: The total doesn't establish that. Regional differences could be hidden, and we haven't reviewed the breakdown.

03 • Operations director: So a drill-down lets us investigate variation, rather than assume the headline applies everywhere.

04 • BI analyst: Correct. It adds detail beneath the dashboard summary while retaining the same metric definition.

05 • Operations director: Should we label one region as the problem area before we open the underlying view?

06 • BI analyst: No. We don't have that evidence yet. The next step is inspection, not a regional conclusion.

07 • Operations director: Please provide a regional view with comparable periods and clearly identified missing data.

08 • BI analyst: I'll check the coverage and denominator so the drill-down doesn't introduce misleading comparisons.

09 • Operations director: Then the executive headline can state the overall result and note that regional analysis is pending.

10 • BI analyst: Yes. It will distinguish what the summary shows from what the detailed view still needs to establish.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Dashboards and Executive Reporting

A KPI card shows a monthly total without its target, comparison period, or definition. The reader cannot interpret whether the result is favorable.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The total needs context. I'll add the definition, reporting period, and relevant comparison so the reader can understand what changed and whether action is needed.

Scenario 2 | The arrow has no comparison label

A fictional KPI card shows 420 and an upward arrow. The comparison period and whether higher is favorable are unspecified. Discuss which labels are needed before the reader can interpret the arrow.

Role A: Dashboard analyst: explain the missing comparison basis.

Role B: Executive reader: ask what the arrow can and cannot mean.

Possible opening: The upward arrow needs a comparison period and metric context before we can call the change favorable.

Success checks

- Do not infer a period or desired direction.
- Distinguish movement from favorable performance.
- Request the metric owner's interpretation basis.

Add a complication: The reader asks to keep the arrow green because upward usually feels positive.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Training attendance and renewal are associated

Fictional analysis discussion using the lesson case: training attendees renew more often, but attendance is voluntary and motivation may differ.

01 • Customer-success director: Training attendees renew more often. Can we say training caused the higher renewal rate?

02 • Analytics lead: The association is observed, but voluntary attendance creates a selection-bias concern about who chooses training.

03 • Customer-success director: You mean motivated customers might both attend and renew, even without a training effect?

04 • Analytics lead: That is one possible confounder, not a measured explanation we have confirmed in this case.

05 • Customer-success director: So correlation describes the pattern, while causation would require stronger support for the effect of attendance.

06 • Analytics lead: Exactly. We should not treat the group difference as an isolated training effect.

07 • Customer-success director: Can we still use the finding to propose further investigation rather than dismiss it as useless?

08 • Analytics lead: Yes. It raises a useful question and can inform a better-designed evaluation with appropriate review.

09 • Customer-success director: I'll describe attendees' higher renewal as an association and keep the motivation hypothesis explicitly tentative.

10 • Analytics lead: I'll bring the group definitions and limits so the recommendation doesn't promise an unestablished causal benefit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Service time fell after two operational changes

Fictional operations analysis: average service time fell after both a staffing change and a new intake form; no separate effects were estimated.

01 • Operations manager: Service time fell after the new intake form. Can we credit the form for the improvement?

02 • Data analyst: Staffing changed during the same period, so the before-and-after comparison doesn't isolate the form's effect.

03 • Operations manager: Then the timing supports a question, but it doesn't rule out another explanation for the change.

04 • Data analyst: Correct. The staffing change is a potential confounder in this comparison, not a confirmed sole cause.

05 • Operations manager: Would saying staffing caused it instead be equally unsupported by the current evidence?

06 • Data analyst: Yes. We should describe the observed decrease and both concurrent changes without assigning causation.

07 • Operations manager: What can I recommend now without pretending the analysis has answered which change mattered?

08 • Data analyst: A focused investigation of comparable periods and available process data, with remaining limitations stated.

09 • Operations manager: I'll keep the operational result visible and replace the causal headline with a bounded description.

10 • Data analyst: I'll outline the evidence needed to examine the explanations rather than choose one by narrative appeal.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A survey describes respondents, not every customer

Fictional survey review: satisfied customers responded more often in a voluntary follow-up; nonrespondents' experiences are unknown.

01 • Experience manager: The voluntary follow-up looks positive. Can we say every customer group is satisfied with the service?

02 • Research analyst: The responses describe respondents. Nonrespondents' experiences are unknown, and participation may be related to satisfaction.

03 • Experience manager: We know satisfied customers responded more often here, so selection bias affects the broad interpretation.

04 • Research analyst: Yes. We should state that pattern without inventing what every nonrespondent would have said.

05 • Experience manager: Could we simply assign negative scores to missing responses to compensate for the bias?

06 • Research analyst: No. That would replace missing evidence with another unsupported assumption rather than solve the sampling problem.

07 • Experience manager: Then our result should report the respondent population and avoid a universal customer claim.

08 • Research analyst: Exactly. We can discuss further outreach or another evaluation approach without promising complete representativeness.

09 • Experience manager: I'll make the response boundary explicit and ask what additional evidence would inform the decision.

10 • Research analyst: I'll bring the participation pattern and limitations so the finding remains useful but appropriately bounded.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Causation, Correlation, and Caveats

Customers who attend training renew more often. Attendance was voluntary, and the groups may differ in motivation.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: Training attendance is associated with renewal in this dataset. That does not establish causation; the groups may differ in other ways. I'll state the finding with that limitation.

Scenario 2 | Adopting teams currently deliver more tasks

In a fictional company, teams that voluntarily adopted a planning tool deliver more tasks. Their performance before adoption has not been compared. Discuss the association and possible selection differences without declaring a tool effect.

Role A: Analytics lead: identify the missing baseline and causal limitation.

Role B: Program sponsor: ask what the current pattern can support.

Possible opening: Adopting teams deliver more tasks, but we haven't compared their performance before adoption.

Success checks

- State the observed association.
- Keep prior performance as an unassessed explanation.
- Recommend a bounded evidence check rather than guaranteed extrapolation.

Add a complication: The sponsor asks to multiply the difference across all teams as guaranteed benefit.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Several payment rows multiply order revenue

Fictional SQL review using the lesson case: order rows join to several payment rows per order, and reported revenue increases after the join.

01 • Reporting analyst: Revenue grows after I join payments. Could you clarify the grain of each source table?

02 • Data engineer: Orders has one row per order; payments can have several rows for the same order.

03 • Reporting analyst: Then an order's revenue may appear repeatedly when its row matches multiple payment records.

04 • Data engineer: Yes. Check that relationship before assuming the larger total represents additional business activity.

05 • Reporting analyst: Would adding DISTINCT to the SQL automatically fix the report without changing its meaning?

06 • Data engineer: Not necessarily. We need the intended reporting grain and measure definition before choosing the transformation.

07 • Reporting analyst: The report is intended to summarize order revenue. I'll confirm how payment details should contribute.

08 • Data engineer: Please inspect matched row counts and a small traceable example with the same join logic.

09 • Reporting analyst: I'll retain the original totals and compare the transformation against those known source records.

10 • Data engineer: Then we can choose logic that preserves the intended unit rather than hide multiplication with an unexplained filter.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A customer changes regions over time

Fictional data-model review: the customer table stores multiple dated region records, and a report joins orders using customer ID alone.

01 • BI developer: My regional order report duplicates some orders. Does the customer table contain one row per customer?

02 • Data modeler: No. It contains dated region records, so a customer can have several rows over time.

03 • BI developer: Then joining only on customer ID doesn't specify which historical region should apply to an order.

04 • Data modeler: Correct. We need the reporting question: region at order time or the customer's current region?

05 • BI developer: That business rule isn't documented. I shouldn't choose the latest row simply because it removes duplicates.

06 • Data modeler: Exactly. A convenient SQL result could answer the wrong business question even with plausible totals.

07 • BI developer: I'll ask the metric owner which time relationship is intended before changing the join logic.

08 • Data modeler: Please also check how overlapping or missing validity periods should be handled, rather than silently guessing.

09 • BI developer: I'll bring those edge cases with a small sample and keep the current report marked under review.

10 • Data modeler: Then the transformation can reflect an explicit grain and time rule instead of accidental matching.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A daily snapshot is not a daily addition

Fictional warehouse report: an inventory table contains daily balance snapshots, and a draft report sums them as if they were daily receipts.

01 • Operations analyst: The monthly inventory number looks huge. Does this table record daily receipts or daily balance snapshots?

02 • Data engineer: It records a balance snapshot for each item each day, not newly received units.

03 • Operations analyst: Then summing every day's balance counts the same continuing stock repeatedly across the month.

04 • Data engineer: Correct. We need to clarify whether the report wants an ending balance, an average, or another measure.

05 • Operations analyst: I shouldn't select month-end automatically because the business question hasn't been confirmed yet.

06 • Data engineer: Exactly. First establish the measure and grain; then choose the SQL transformation that answers it.

07 • Operations analyst: Could you identify the snapshot date field and any days missing from the source?

08 • Data engineer: I'll provide that context, but the business owner still needs to confirm the intended inventory question.

09 • Operations analyst: I'll ask them and compare a small item history before changing the dashboard calculation.

10 • Data engineer: Good. The corrected logic should reflect what the rows mean, not merely produce a smaller number.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | SQL, Models, and Transformation Logic

A report joins order rows to several payment rows per order. Revenue appears larger after the join.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: What does one row represent in each table? The join may repeat order values when there are multiple payments. Let's check the grain and aggregation before interpreting the total.

Scenario 2 | One customer appears in several campaign groups

A fictional customer table joins to campaign membership with multiple rows per customer. The report requests unique customers reached, but the draft counts joined rows. Clarify the unit and join relationship without prescribing an unexplained SQL shortcut.

Role A: BI analyst: ask about membership grain and the desired customer measure.

Role B: Marketing data owner: distinguish campaign memberships from unique people.

Possible opening: Does each joined row represent a customer or a campaign membership for that customer?

Success checks

- Identify the one-to-many relationship.
- Use the intended entity and verified identifier.
- Agree a traceable sample check before changing the calculation.

Add a complication: The owner suggests deleting repeated names, although different customers can share names.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The estimate needs its uncertainty interval

Fictional experiment readout using the lesson case: the point estimate is positive, but its interval includes values near no change; the slide omits the interval.

01 • Decision sponsor: The slide shows a positive effect. Can I treat that number as the established improvement?

02 • Experiment analyst: It is the point estimate. Its confidence interval includes values close to no change, which the slide omits.

03 • Decision sponsor: So the estimate summarizes the observed result, but the uncertainty affects how strongly we should interpret it.

04 • Experiment analyst: Yes. We should present the effect size and interval together, using the method's stated assumptions.

05 • Decision sponsor: Does an interval near no change prove that the treatment has no useful effect?

06 • Experiment analyst: No. It indicates uncertainty under the analysis; it doesn't justify that opposite certainty either.

07 • Decision sponsor: Please also include sample size and the guardrail results so one favorable number doesn't carry the decision.

08 • Experiment analyst: I'll check those records and distinguish completed analysis from any results still pending.

09 • Decision sponsor: Then the recommendation can reflect practical importance and uncertainty instead of promising the point estimate.

10 • Experiment analyst: Agreed. I'll revise the readout so its conclusion stays within the evidence we actually have.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A relative lift needs the absolute change

Fictional experiment: conversion rises from 2% to 2.2%; uncertainty analysis and guardrail review are not complete.

01 • Product sponsor: A ten percent lift sounds substantial. Is that the clearest way to present this conversion result?

02 • Data scientist: Include the absolute change too: two percent to two-point-two percent is a zero-point-two percentage-point increase.

03 • Product sponsor: Then ten percent describes relative change, not ten additional percentage points of conversion.

04 • Data scientist: Correct. Both can be reported, but the distinction matters when judging practical effect size.

05 • Product sponsor: Can the size of the relative lift tell us the result is statistically reliable?

06 • Data scientist: Not by itself. Uncertainty analysis is incomplete, and the guardrail review is still pending.

07 • Product sponsor: I'll keep the observed rates but avoid calling the treatment a confirmed success today.

08 • Data scientist: Please also include the sample-size context once verified, rather than presenting the percentage without its basis.

09 • Product sponsor: At the readout, we'll ask whether the effect is useful and supported, not just whether it sounds large.

10 • Data scientist: I'll bring the completed analysis and clearly identify any remaining uncertainty before that decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An unplanned subgroup result needs a caveat

Fictional experiment review: the overall estimate is modest, and an exploratory subgroup shows a larger estimate; the subgroup was selected after examining results.

01 • Business lead: This subgroup has a much larger estimate. Can we make it the headline experiment result?

02 • Experiment analyst: It was selected after we examined the results, so we should label that analysis exploratory.

03 • Business lead: Does exploratory mean the observed subgroup estimate is wrong and should be removed entirely?

04 • Experiment analyst: No. It can suggest a follow-up question, but it doesn't have the same status as the planned comparison.

05 • Business lead: We also need its sample size and uncertainty, rather than assume a bigger estimate is more dependable.

06 • Experiment analyst: Exactly. Smaller subgroups and multiple examined comparisons can complicate interpretation under the chosen analysis.

07 • Business lead: I'll keep the overall result visible and describe the subgroup as a hypothesis-generating observation.

08 • Experiment analyst: Good. We should retain the selection history instead of rewriting it as a prespecified test.

09 • Business lead: Could we propose a targeted future evaluation without promising the larger effect will repeat?

10 • Experiment analyst: Yes. That is a bounded recommendation, with the current evidence and guardrail questions clearly stated.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Experiment Readouts and Statistical Thinking

An experiment estimates a positive effect, but the interval includes values close to no change. The slide presents only the point estimate.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: I'll show the estimated effect and its uncertainty together. The point estimate alone hides the range of values compatible with the analysis and can make the result sound more certain than it is.

Scenario 2 | A larger sample from a different population

A fictional team proposes combining a small customer experiment with a large employee trial to increase sample size. The populations differ, and comparability has not been assessed. Discuss why more observations alone do not settle the interpretation.

Role A: Experiment analyst: explain the population mismatch.

Role B: Decision sponsor: ask whether separate results would be more informative.

Possible opening: Combining the trials increases the count, but we haven't established that employees and customers answer the same research question.

Success checks

- Distinguish precision from population relevance.
- Do not claim a pooled effect is valid before review.
- Agree to assess comparability and report groups transparently.

Add a complication: The sponsor asks to pool them without a caveat because the interval may become narrower.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Which customer fields are actually needed?

Fictional governance request using the lesson case: an analyst requests customer-level data without specifying fields or retention duration.

01 • Data steward: Could you specify the fields, analytical purpose, and requested retention period for this customer-level dataset?

02 • Analyst: I asked for the full table, but I haven't explained which variables answer my question.

03 • Data steward: Please narrow that request before access review so privacy and access-control requirements can be assessed.

04 • Analyst: Would removing names mean the entire table is automatically appropriate for my analysis?

05 • Data steward: No. Other fields may remain sensitive or identifying, and authorization still needs to be checked.

06 • Analyst: I'll describe the question and ask whether an aggregated dataset could answer it instead.

07 • Data steward: Good. Also state the requested review timing without treating urgency as approval to bypass governance.

08 • Analyst: I'll submit the scoped request before our planning meeting and identify retention as needing owner confirmation.

09 • Data steward: I'll return any missing-information questions through the approved channel and keep access pending review.

10 • Analyst: Understood. I won't download customer-level records while the authorized scope is still unresolved.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An external collaborator needs a reviewed extract

Fictional analytics collaboration: an external researcher requests transaction-level records; field necessity, authorization, and transfer method are unconfirmed.

01 • Research coordinator: Our collaborator wants the transaction-level file. Could you send it so the analysis can begin?

02 • Data governance lead: First provide the purpose, required fields, recipient details, and proposed retention period for review.

03 • Research coordinator: They already work with us on another project. Does that previous collaboration establish access here?

04 • Data governance lead: Not automatically. This dataset and purpose need their own authorization and appropriate secure-handling assessment.

05 • Research coordinator: Could we ask whether a smaller aggregate extract would meet the same analytical need?

06 • Data governance lead: Yes. That is a useful scope question, but the proposed extract still needs the applicable review.

07 • Research coordinator: I'll request the collaborator's minimum requirements and avoid sending records through ordinary email meanwhile.

08 • Data governance lead: Please include the needed decision timing so the responsible owners can coordinate their response.

09 • Research coordinator: I'll explain that analysis start remains conditional on approved access and transfer arrangements.

10 • Data governance lead: Good. We'll assess a specific request rather than infer permission from an existing professional relationship.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A temporary extract remains in a shared folder

Fictional data review: an extract created for a completed analysis remains in a shared folder; its authorized retention period is unknown.

01 • Analytics manager: The analysis is finished, but its temporary extract is still in the shared folder.

02 • Data steward: Please identify the extract owner and approved retention basis before deciding what should happen next.

03 • Analytics manager: Could we delete it immediately because temporary always means it should disappear after the presentation?

04 • Data steward: We shouldn't invent a retention rule. Check the applicable requirements and any legitimate preservation obligations with the owner.

05 • Analytics manager: The authorized retention period isn't recorded here, so both continued storage and deletion need clarification.

06 • Data steward: Correct. Also confirm current access scope through the established review process rather than assuming the folder is restricted.

07 • Analytics manager: I'll request the retention and access records today and flag the missing documentation explicitly.

08 • Data steward: Thank you. Avoid copying the extract into another location just to make the review easier.

09 • Analytics manager: I'll provide its reference and purpose through the governance channel, keeping the data in place pending direction.

10 • Data steward: Then the authorized owner can decide the appropriate handling based on actual requirements, not a guessed deadline.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Data Governance and Privacy

An analyst wants customer-level data but has not specified which fields are needed or how long they will be retained.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you define the analysis purpose, necessary fields, and retention period? That will let the appropriate team review access and privacy requirements before the data is shared.

Scenario 2 | A screenshot includes customer identifiers

A fictional analyst wants to show a dashboard screenshot in an external presentation. Customer identifiers are visible, and publication approval has not been checked. Request a reviewed alternative without declaring that simple masking guarantees privacy.

Role A: Data steward: ask what information the presentation needs and who approves sharing.

Role B: Analyst: propose a synthetic or aggregated example for review.

Possible opening: The screenshot includes customer identifiers; could we use a reviewed example that contains only what the presentation needs?

Success checks

- Distinguish reduced exposure from verified approval.
- Request the minimum necessary presentation content.
- Keep external sharing pending the appropriate review.

Add a complication: The analyst says cropping the names alone proves the image is safe.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Ten findings need one decision-focused recommendation

Separate fictional executive readout: a report lists ten findings. Eight of ten delayed service tickets lack handoff timestamps, preventing a complete timeline reconstruction. The cause of delay and reason for the missing timestamps are unknown. The audience has five minutes to consider an investigation.

01 • Service director: We have five minutes. What decision does this report support?

02 • BI analyst: A focused service investigation, not acceptance of an unconfirmed cause.

03 • Service director: How does an insight differ from a recommendation?

04 • BI analyst: An insight interprets a pattern; a recommendation proposes action based on evidence and its limits.

05 • Service director: Which findings support that next best action, and which are only background for today's decision?

06 • BI analyst: Eight of ten delayed tickets lack handoff timestamps. Reviewing how handoffs are recorded could clarify the incomplete service timeline.

07 • Service director: Don't invent a cause to make the story sound decisive.

08 • BI analyst: Agreed. The missing timestamps don't explain the delays. I propose that the service owner review those eight ticket histories.

09 • Service director: Then end with the decision ask: whether to authorize that investigation, not whether to accept an unproven explanation.

10 • BI analyst: Please authorize that bounded records review; it could identify available timeline evidence, but its findings and the delay cause remain unknown.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A queue pattern suggests where to look first

Fictional service analysis: delays are concentrated in the intake queue during the observed week; staffing and demand causes have not been assessed.

01 • Operations sponsor: The intake queue has most of the observed delay. Should we immediately add more staff there?

02 • Analytics lead: The pattern identifies where to investigate, but it doesn't establish staffing as the cause or solution.

03 • Operations sponsor: Then what is the useful insight, and how does it differ from a hiring recommendation?

04 • Analytics lead: The insight is the concentration of delay in intake during this week. Hiring requires additional evidence and authority.

05 • Operations sponsor: Could the next best action be to review intake demand and handling steps with the process owner?

06 • Analytics lead: Yes. That is bounded and directly related to the observed pattern without assuming the explanation.

07 • Operations sponsor: Please state the week in the headline so readers don't interpret this as a permanent condition.

08 • Analytics lead: I'll do that and identify any measurement limitations before we generalize to other periods.

09 • Operations sponsor: I'll authorize a discussion with the process owner, not an immediate staffing change from this chart.

10 • Analytics lead: I'll bring the supporting breakdown and frame the open question clearly for that investigation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Recommend a check before replacing a supplier

Fictional delivery analysis: one supplier has a higher recorded late-delivery rate, but requested delivery windows differ across suppliers.

01 • Procurement manager: This supplier has the highest recorded late rate. Should the recommendation be to replace them?

02 • BI analyst: Not yet. Requested delivery windows differ, so the raw ranking isn't a matched performance comparison.

03 • Procurement manager: Then the report should explain that limitation before presenting replacement as the next best action.

04 • BI analyst: Correct. A useful recommendation is to compare equivalent delivery commitments and verify how lateness is defined.

05 • Procurement manager: Does that mean we should ignore the observed ranking until a perfect dataset exists?

06 • BI analyst: No. Retain it as a signal for investigation, with the comparison assumption clearly stated.

07 • Procurement manager: Can you give the procurement team a focused question rather than ten possible analyses?

08 • BI analyst: Ask whether the difference persists when comparable requested windows and counting rules are used.

09 • Procurement manager: I'll request that review before making a supplier decision, and keep other decision criteria separate.

10 • BI analyst: I'll deliver the bounded comparison and distinguish what it reveals from any commercial recommendation requiring broader judgment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Insight Storytelling and Recommendations

A report lists ten findings but no recommended action. The audience has five minutes to decide whether to investigate a service issue.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: I'll lead with the finding relevant to that decision, explain its limitation, and recommend a specific investigation. The other findings can support the discussion without obscuring the request.

Scenario 2 | A recommendation depends on an unverified address field

A fictional report recommends contacting customers in one region, but the region field may refer to billing rather than service location. The field definition is unverified. Explain why the next action should begin with clarification.

Role A: Analytics lead: identify the assumption beneath the recommendation.

Role B: Service manager: ask what can be decided before outreach begins.

Possible opening: The outreach recommendation depends on what region means, and that field definition is still unverified.

Success checks

- State the dependency between definition and action.
- Avoid presenting billing location as confirmed service location.
- Recommend an owner-confirmed definition check before outreach.

Add a complication: The manager wants to contact the listed customers first and clarify afterward.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Data Analytics and Business Intelligence English

Professional audience: data analysts, BI developers, analytics engineers, data scientists, reporting teams, business analysts, and data-driven managers

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Dialogue 01: Agreeing on a metric

Original fictional setting: An analyst and stakeholder define active customers.

Professional roles: BI analyst / Sales operations manager

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

BI analyst: Does active customer mean a signed contract or a purchase in the reporting period?

Sales operations manager: For this dashboard, at least one completed purchase in the last 90 days.

BI analyst: Should canceled and fully refunded orders count?

Sales operations manager: No. Let's write those exclusions into the definition.

BI analyst: I'll document the time zone, source tables, and refresh schedule too.

Sales operations manager: Send the definition for review before building the chart so other teams can use the same measure.

Vocabulary in this exchange: dashboard: Visual summary of selected measures used to monitor status, performance, or risk.

END REFERENCE**TASK: Interactive workplace role-play**

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Data Analytics and Business Intelligence English

Professional audience: data analysts, BI developers, analytics engineers, data scientists, reporting teams, business analysts, and data-driven managers

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Dialogue 01: Agreeing on a metric

Original fictional setting: An analyst and stakeholder define active customers.

Professional roles: BI analyst / Sales operations manager

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

BI analyst: Does active customer mean a signed contract or a purchase in the reporting period?

Sales operations manager: For this dashboard, at least one completed purchase in the last 90 days.

BI analyst: Should canceled and fully refunded orders count?

Sales operations manager: No. Let's write those exclusions into the definition.

BI analyst: I'll document the time zone, source tables, and refresh schedule too.

Sales operations manager: Send the definition for review before building the chart so other teams can use the same measure.

Vocabulary in this exchange: dashboard: Visual summary of selected measures used to monitor status, performance, or risk.

END REFERENCE**TASK:** Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level